Aishwarya Rai) actually invoked the figure of a ‘rogue security agent’ acting to protect what he thinks are the interests of the nation state, by seeking to eliminate what we are at first led to believe is a ‘suspected terrorist mastermind’—a Dr Ansari, whose appearance, demeanour and dignified silence, particularly in the first half of the film, cannot but fail to bring to mind what we know of S.A.R. Geelani. Ansari is later revealed to be someone who knows ‘vital information’ about the engineering of a communal riot by corrupt politicians (shades of ‘Gujarat 2002’ here) and his silence is an effort to protect what he knows so that he can reveal it at the most appropriate moment. Although the film follows the formula of good cops versus ‘rogue’ cops (not exactly ‘bad’ cops, but cops used by shadowy forces within the state beyond their control), it again points out the macabrely pantomimic character of ‘war against terror’.

What do *Dil Se*, *Mission Kashmir*, *16 December* on the one hand, and the Zee TV docu-dramas add up to? They add up to the metaphorical identikit photograph of the terrorist in our heads whom we can recognize when we look at almost anyone’s face, regardless of whether they ‘stand out’ or ‘blend in’. This is the terrorist writ large as ‘everyman’, so much so that Zee TV can use the footage from the ‘re-enacted’ scenes of the ‘13 December’ film even in another programme, an ‘Inside Story’ special broadcast on ‘the Al Qaeda Terror Manual’ on the evening of 24 July 2005, in the wake of the London bombings of 7 July and barely days before the final Supreme Court verdict on the 13 December case on 4 August. This programme, which can be seen as a sort of do-it-yourself ‘how to become a terrorist even if you never thought of becoming one’, with details of how to obtain and mix chemicals to make bombs, the details of poisoning drinking water systems, how to form cells and conduct communications using codes, etc. (in a classic example of the ‘system’ actually egging people on to become the ‘terrorists’ that it can then frighten the rest of us with) again used the same scenes of the actors playing Geelani, Shaukat, Afzal and the five dead men, though this time it did not name them. But anyone who had seen the earlier ‘13 December’ film would immediately recognize once again the fictionalized S.A.R. Geelani hectoring his cell comrades in the sequence on ‘organization of terrorist cells’. Just as anyone who had seen the ‘13 December’ film would have seen the gratuitous and grainy images of ‘terrorists’ training under pine trees and of a televised ‘encounter’ with the late and larger-than-life ‘Ghazi Baba’ caressing a strangely shaped ‘Scorpion’ pistol in what was marked ‘file footage’. Like a